



The Hermitage

Catherine built the Winter Palace in St. Petersburg. She called it the Hermitage, because it allowed her to shut herself and her court away like hermits. Today it is a famous museum.

The playing of music was encouraged at court. Catherine invited foreign musicians to Russia to perform their work.

During court entertainments the wearing of masks became popular.

The court entertainments were dazzling to look at, with gorgeous costumes.

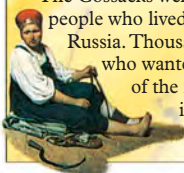


The nobles dressed in clothes that came from fashionable France. They were the finest clothes money could buy.

Revolt of the serfs

In 1771, a Cossack soldier named Emilian Pugachev set himself up as a rival emperor to Catherine.

The Cossacks were a warlike people who lived in southern Russia. Thousands of serfs who wanted to get rid of the nobles joined in their revolt.



The number of rebels under Pugachev grew and, in 1773, they swarmed across Russia, destroying the city of Kazan. Catherine ordered her army to attack the rebels and, in July 1774, the serfs were defeated. Pugachev was captured, brought to Moscow, and executed. The revolt was over.

